



THE ANIMAL KINGDOM

Almost two million species of animals have so far been identified—and it is thought that the true number may be several times greater than this. Members of the animal kingdom range from invertebrates that are too small to be seen with the naked eye to the blue whale, which is more than 100ft (30m) long. The variety of lifestyles is equally immense, from animals that filter food from water while permanently fixed to the seafloor to agile predators that can travel across the ground at more than 60mph (100kph). This section reflects the great diversity of the animal kingdom, profiling over 2,000 species, from the largest and best known to the tiniest and most obscure.